

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In her 2019 poetry collection *Salt Weather*, Nadia Oyelaran uses images of the natural world to convey a speaker's grief.

Which quotation from *Salt Weather* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "The tide comes in and takes the footprints one by one, / as if the sea had come to collect what I could not keep."

B: "I wept until the morning, and then I wept some more, / and the clock upon the wall kept time with my complaint."

C: "The heron stands in shallow water, patient as a stone, / and watches for the silver flick beneath the surface."

D: "My grandmother's coat still hangs behind the door; / no one has moved it, and no one ever will."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the claim has TWO halves -- nature imagery AND grief. B has grief but a clock (not nature); C has nature but no grief; D has grief but a coat. Only A carries both.

Shortcut: underline each requirement in the claim and check both are present.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Scholar Ines Duval notes that in Tomas Reinhardt's 2020 novel *The Quiet Ledger*, the character Anton hides his disappointment behind ordinary politeness.

Which quotation from *The Quiet Ledger* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Anton slammed the ledger shut and said that he had expected better from all of them."

B: "Anton had never been disappointed in his life, or so he liked to tell the junior clerks each morning."

C: "Anton read the letter twice, folded it into his breast pocket, and asked whether anyone would like more tea."

D: "Margit could see the disappointment in Anton's face before he had finished the first paragraph."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: D is the trap -- it proves he IS disappointed, but if others can see it, it is not hidden. Shortcut: for a concealment claim, the right quote must show the feeling AND show it going unnoticed.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In her 2021 novel *The Longwater Road*, Priyanka Menon conveys the isolation of her protagonist, Fen, through descriptions of the physical environment.

Which quotation from *The Longwater Road* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Fen had no friends in the village and did not expect to make any."

B: "The village held a festival each autumn, and the square filled with lanterns and the smell of roasting corn."

C: "Fen thought often of her sister, who had written once and then not again."

D: "From Fen's window there was one road, and it ran to the horizon without meeting another."

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: A states the isolation directly, which feels like the "obvious" answer -- but the claim says the isolation is conveyed THROUGH the environment. Shortcut: when a claim names a method, a quote that skips the method and states the point is wrong.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Critic Hugo Baptiste argues that in Amara Nwosu's 2018 play *The Ferryman's Daughter*, the sisters Ola and Chidera are defined by their opposing attitudes toward risk.

Which quotation from *The Ferryman's Daughter* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: OLA: I have counted every coin in this house three times, and I will count them again before I sleep.

B: OLA: We should wait until the water is calm. CHIDERA: The water is never calm. That is why I am going now.

C: CHIDERA: Our father crossed this river a thousand times and never once asked permission of it.

D: OLA: Chidera, you were always the louder of us, even as a child.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: A and C each show one sister's attitude convincingly, but a contrast claim needs BOTH sides in the same quote. D gives a difference, but about volume, not risk. Shortcut: count the characters the claim requires.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In his 1912 poem "Letters to the Ice," Everett Slade creates the impression that the speaker is addressing someone who cannot answer.

Which quotation from "Letters to the Ice" most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "I ask you, as I asked last year, and as I will ask next: / does the cold reach you where you are?"

B: "The men returned with maps and stories, and we listened to them all."

C: "You said the ice would hold, and it held, and we went across."

D: "I write these words in a book that no one reads but me."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: C has direct address ("You"), which pattern-matches the claim -- but that person DID speak. D has silence but no one being addressed. Shortcut: the claim needs address plus non-response; check for both, not just one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In her 2022 short story "Shiftwork," Delia Vance uses repetition to suggest the monotony of the narrator's daily routine.

Which quotation from "Shiftwork" most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "The factory was old, and the machines were older, and no one had repaired the eastern door in twenty years."

B: "I hated the sound of the whistle more than I have ever hated anything."

C: "Badge in, coat off, gloves on. Badge in, coat off, gloves on. Badge in, coat off, gloves on."

D: "Every morning I told myself that this would be the last month, and every morning I did not believe it."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: D is the strong trap -- it genuinely repeats ("every morning") and describes a routine, but what it conveys is self-deception, not monotony. Shortcut: match the repetition to the EFFECT named in the claim, not just to the presence of repetition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Scholar Rafael Ortiz observes that in Junko Arai's 2017 novel *The Paper Loom*, the narrator's respect for her mother's craft develops slowly over many years.

Which quotation from *The Paper Loom* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "The moment I saw the finished cloth, I understood everything my mother had tried to tell me."

B: "My mother was the finest weaver in the province, and everyone knew it, including me."

C: "I was twelve, and I thought the loom was a foolish way to spend a life."

D: "At twelve I found the loom tedious; at twenty, merely difficult; at thirty-five I sat down at it and could not stand up again until dark."

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: A shows respect arriving, but in a single moment -- the claim says SLOWLY. B shows respect already fixed. Shortcut: a "develops over time" claim needs at least two time markers in the quote.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Critic Sofia Almeida argues that in Gerald Tan's 2019 novel *The Standing Water*, the narrator reveals more about his own motives than he appears to realize.

Which quotation from *The Standing Water* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "I knew perfectly well why I had come, and I saw no reason to pretend otherwise."

B: "I had no interest in the house, none at all, and I drove past it only twice that week, or perhaps three times."

C: "I have never been an honest man, and this account will be no exception."

D: "My brother believed I had come for the inheritance, but my brother believed many foolish things."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: C looks perfect because it is about unreliability -- but a narrator who ANNOUNCES he is unreliable is fully aware. The claim needs a slip. In B the denial collapses inside its own sentence. Shortcut: look for self-contradiction, not self-diagnosis.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In her 2020 essay collection *Ground Truth*, Marisol Ferrer argues that scientific fieldwork changes not only what researchers know but also how they see ordinary places.

Which quotation from *Ground Truth* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "After the survey ended I could not walk through any park without reading the soil, the drainage, the age of every tree."

B: "We collected four thousand samples, and by the end we understood the watershed better than anyone had before."

C: "The field station was cold, and we complained about it for six weeks without stopping."

D: "I have always loved walking, and fieldwork gave me a great deal of it."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: B satisfies the "not only" half (knowledge gained) and stops there. The claim's weight is on the "but also" half. Shortcut: in a "not only X but also Y" claim, Y is what the quote must prove.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Scholar Petra Lindgren notes that in Kwame Asante's 2021 play *Harvest Table*, the conflict between father and son emerges through what the characters decline to say.

Which quotation from *Harvest Table* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: KOJO: You have never once approved of anything I have done, and we both know it.

B: FATHER: Sit down. Eat. The stew is getting cold and your mother worked all day.

C: FATHER: And the university? KOJO: The stew is very good. FATHER: Yes. It is.

D: KOJO: I am leaving in the morning. FATHER: Then leave in the morning.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: D is terse and tense, so it feels like avoidance -- but both men say exactly what they mean. In C a question is asked and deliberately dodged. Shortcut: find the quote where a topic is raised and then abandoned.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In his 2018 novel *The Cartographer's Error*, Idris Haddad often places a character's confident prediction directly beside the event that contradicts it.

Which quotation from *The Cartographer's Error* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Selim had never trusted the maps, and he was proved right within the hour."

B: "The expedition failed, as expeditions often do, for reasons no one had thought to write down."

C: "Selim wondered whether the pass would be open, and he wondered about it for a long while."

D: "There is no river here, Selim announced, and he was still saying it when the water reached his knees."

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: A has a prediction and a fast outcome -- but the outcome CONFIRMS him. The claim requires contradiction. Shortcut: check the direction of the outcome, not just the speed of it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Critic Yuki Tanaka argues that Beatriz Solano's 2019 poem "The Commons" presents work as a shared undertaking rather than an individual achievement.

Which quotation from "The Commons" most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "I laid the first stone at dawn and the last at dusk, / and I laid them well."

B: "No hand among us finished what it started; / the wall rose because none of us worked alone."

C: "The village had a wall, and the wall had a gate, / and the gate was never locked."

D: "My father built, and his father built, / and I have built as they did."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: D is the sharp trap -- it spans a whole family, so it feels collective. But each generation works alone, in sequence. Shared work means simultaneous and interdependent.

Shortcut: ask whether the workers are together or merely similar.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Scholar Adaeze Okafor observes that in Lena Vasquez's 2022 novel *The Salt Roads*, the character Teodora accepts her inheritance without ever embracing it.

Which quotation from *The Salt Roads* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Teodora refused the keys and told the lawyer to give them to the sea."

B: "Teodora took the keys, hung them on the nail by the door, and did not touch them again for a year."

C: "Teodora had waited her whole life for the house, and now the house was hers."

D: "Teodora asked what the taxes would be, and whether the roof had been repaired."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the claim is a middle position, so both extremes (A refusal, C enthusiasm) are wrong. D is the subtle trap: asking about taxes and roofs is engagement. Shortcut: for "X without Y" claims, the quote must show X happening and Y failing to happen.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In her 2020 novel *The Understudy*, Colette Renard conveys a character's presence through its effect on other people rather than through description of the character herself.

Which quotation from *The Understudy* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "She was tall, with dark hair cut short, and she wore the same grey coat every day."

B: "No one in the company knew where she had come from, and no one asked."

C: "When she entered, the room did not fall silent so much as rearrange itself; three people stood who had been sitting."

D: "She spoke rarely, and when she spoke her voice was low."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: D feels indirect because it is understated -- but it still describes HER (her speech, her voice). Shortcut: check whose behavior the quote reports. The claim demands the camera point at everyone else.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Scholar Ravi Chandrasekhar notes that in Ottoline Frere's 1928 poem "The Instrument," a single comparison is sustained and developed rather than stated once and abandoned.

Which quotation from "The Instrument" most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Grief is a violin: first the tuning, which is worst; / then the long practice, which is only slightly better; / then the day you play without looking at your hands."

B: "Grief is a violin, and sorrow is a bow, / and the room is very cold."

C: "Grief came like a violin into the house, and then it stayed."

D: "I took up the violin the year my mother died, / and I have played it every year since."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: B contains MORE comparisons, so it looks richer -- but the claim wants one comparison extended, not several piled up. C states the comparison and drops it. Shortcut: count how many lines the same image survives across.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Critic Bengt Aaltonen argues that in Hana Prokopova's 2021 novel *The Ninth Hour*, Vera's sense of herself as unremarkable is contradicted by the way others behave toward her.

Which quotation from *The Ninth Hour* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Vera had never thought of herself as remarkable, and in this she was entirely correct."

B: "The others deferred to Vera in everything, and Vera enjoyed it more than she admitted."

C: "Vera was the youngest in the department and the least experienced, a fact she mentioned often."

D: "I am nobody here, Vera said, and around the table four people put down their pens and waited for her to continue."

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: B shows others deferring, which is half the claim -- but Vera notices and enjoys it, so her self-image is not modest. A confirms her view instead of contradicting it.

Shortcut: the quote must contain the belief and the evidence against it, side by side.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Scholar Aurelie Dupont observes that in Nikhil Raghunath's 2019 memoir *Downriver*, the same event is recalled differently at different points in the author's life, suggesting that memory is remade rather than retrieved.

Which quotation from *Downriver* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "I remember the flood as clearly as if it had happened this morning, down to the color of the water."

B: "At ten I remembered a boat; at thirty, a raft; at fifty I am no longer sure there was anything to stand on at all."

C: "My sister remembers the flood differently than I do, and we have long since stopped arguing about it."

D: "Memory is a poor witness, as every court has learned, and mine is poorer than most."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: C is the hardest trap -- it shows memory being unreliable, but across two PEOPLE. The claim specifies one person across TIME. D states the idea instead of illustrating it. Shortcut: check whether the variation is between people or within a life.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In her 2020 novel *The Weight of Salt*, Imogen Farrow presents Ruth as someone who arranges outcomes deliberately while allowing others to believe those outcomes happened by chance.

Which quotation from *The Weight of Salt* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Ruth had planned every detail of the evening and told everyone so, twice."

B: "By pure luck the two of them were seated together, and Ruth was as surprised as anyone."

C: "Ruth had rewritten the seating card an hour before the guests arrived, and when they thanked fate for the arrangement she agreed that fate had been kind."

D: "Ruth never left anything to chance; her sisters found this exhausting."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: D captures her deliberateness perfectly and is the most tempting -- but her sisters know, so nothing is disguised. A announces the planning outright. Shortcut: the claim has a concealment clause; the quote must show the credit going elsewhere.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Critic Tomas Vieira argues that in Selin Aydin's 2022 poem "After the Notice," the landscape is presented as wholly unaffected by the speaker's circumstances.

Which quotation from "After the Notice" most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "The letter came. The orchard did what orchards do in April, / which is everything, and all of it without me."

B: "The sky went dark the hour the letter came, / as though it too had read the thing."

C: "I walked into the orchard and could not remember why I had come."

D: "The orchard had been my father's, and before that his mother's, / and now it would be no one's."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: B is the reversal trap -- the landscape responds to the speaker, which is the opposite of indifference, but it feels "poetic" and gets picked. Shortcut: for indifference claims, reject any quote where nature reacts.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Scholar Mireille Lafond notes that Osei Boateng's 2021 poem "Provision" repeatedly poses questions that the poem itself declines to resolve.

Which quotation from "Provision" most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Who fed us in those years? My mother fed us. / Who clothed us? My mother, again."

B: "I have questions for the man who left, / but he has been gone a long while."

C: "What is a house? A house is a roof and a wall / and a door that closes."

D: "What did she give up? The poem does not know. / What did it cost her? The poem does not know that either."

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: A and C both pose questions repeatedly, matching half the claim -- then answer them immediately. B mentions questions without asking any. Shortcut: for "poses but does not resolve," verify the answer is actually withheld.

END QUESTION